Mark Scheme — Vocabulary Test 3

Section A — Vocabulary in Context

(a) 'engrossing spectacle' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each bullet up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- ('engrossing') absorbing / captivating / fascinating / holding attention completely / compelling / gripping
- ('spectacle') sight / show / display / event / something impressive to watch / visual experience

Guidance: Do NOT credit 'interesting' alone (too weak). LOOK FOR total absorption of attention.

(b) 'obvious insincerity' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each bullet up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- ('obvious') clear / easily noticed / unmistakable / plain to see / evident / apparent
- ('insincerity') dishonesty / not meaning what he said / fakeness / lack of genuine feeling / pretending / duplicity

Guidance: Do NOT credit 'lying' alone. LOOK FOR saying things one does not mean.

Section B — Word Choice

(c) 'loomed rather than stood' **[1 mark]**

Award 1 mark for any of the following:

- loomed suggests the building is threatening / imposing / menacing / dominating / intimidating
- stood is neutral; loomed implies it towers over in a frightening or oppressive way

Guidance: LOOK FOR any suggestion of threat, dominance, or intimidation.

(d) 'slanted rather than one-sided' **[1 mark]**

Award 1 mark for any of the following:

- slanted suggests deliberate distortion / tilting the facts / manipulating the truth on purpose
- one-sided just means incomplete; slanted implies intentional bias / dishonesty in reporting

Guidance: LOOK FOR deliberate manipulation. ACCEPT 'twisted' / 'angled unfairly'.

Section C — Writer's Effect

(e) 'scorched' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each idea up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- the fields are burned / dried out / destroyed by heat / blackened / dead / parched
- total devastation / nothing can survive / lifeless / barren
- creates hopelessness / despair // the reader feels sad / melancholic

Guidance: Focus on destruction by heat. NOT: 'hot' / 'sunny' alone.

MISS JAY
O & A LEVEL ENGLISH

Jaweria Amer

(f) 'mottled' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each idea up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- his hands are marked with patches / uneven colour / blotched / spotted / discoloured
- he is old / frail / ageing / his body is deteriorating / worn by time
- creates sympathy / pity // the reader feels sad / concerned for him

Guidance: LOOK FOR ageing, frailty, or physical decline. NOT: 'dirty' / 'ugly'.

Section D — Word Bank Answers

(g) glee — Exuberant delight / lively, open joy / elation

(h) portrays — Represents / depicts someone in a particular way

(i) fare — The range or type of content offered (e.g. TV programmes) / output

(j) distort — To give a false or misleading impression / misrepresent / twist

(k) gullible — Easily deceived / too quick to believe things / naive

(l) gargantuan — Enormous / of extraordinary size / colossal

Distractors (unused): comprise, bombarded

Mark Breakdown:

Section A — Vocabulary in Context (a-b)	4
Section B — Word Choice (c-d)	2
Section C — Writer's Effect (e-f)	4
Section D — Word Bank (g-l)	6
TOTAL	**16**

END OF MARKING SCHEME — TEST 3

MISS JAY
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